Nationality: American
Marital: Single
Dependants: None

Ken Austria

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Currently Based: Beijing, China

Profile

U.S. Teaching License: Computer Science (Grades 7–12) and English as a Second Language (Grades PreK–12). U.S.-educated (PreK–12 & B.A.) and native English speaker.

Results-driven Computer Science and Mathematics educator and native English speaker with a background in Software Engineering and Psychology, offering proven expertise delivering AP, OSSD, and Cambridge IGCSE curricula. Experienced in designing rigorous, standards-aligned coursework and building data-driven learning systems that foster computational thinking and advanced mathematical reasoning. Proven track record in curriculum design, school-wide coordination, and leveraging educational technology to drive student engagement and postsecondary success.

Philosophy

I believe effective teaching balances rigor with accessibility, using data-informed instruction, scaffolded learning, and real-world applications. I prioritize student agency, critical thinking, and inclusive classrooms that support diverse learners in achieving measurable growth.

Qualifications

- **U.S. Standard Teaching License –** State ID: DC8477693810 **Expires March 2030**
    - Subject: Computer Science (Grades 7–12); English as a Second Language (ESL, PreK–12)
- **Bachelor of Arts: Psychology,** California State University: Sacramento, United States **May 2010**
- **Native English Speaker** with 5+ years of international teaching experience.

Certifications & Professional Development

- **120 - Hour Teaching English as a Foreign Language,** United Kingdom **July 2021**
- **Full Stack Software Engineering Immersive,** App Academy **February 2019**
- **Front End Development,** Codecademy **January 2017**

Experience

Computer Science and Math Teacher **Shuren Ribet Private School** **August 2026 – Present**
Education Team Beijing, China

- Computer Science: Designed and delivered a comprehensive, multi-tiered Computer Science curriculum spanning Grades 9–12, integrating foundational digital literacy (ICT), intermediate programming in Python, and rigorous AP Computer Science to develop computational thinking and core software engineering skills.
- Mathematics: Instructed high-rigor secondary mathematics courses, including Cambridge IGCSE International Mathematics (Grade 9), employing analytical problem-solving frameworks to build advanced algebraic fluency.

Leadership & Coordination **Pegasus California School** **August 2024 – Present**
Education Team Qingdao, Shandong, China

- Coordinated the school-wide mandatory clubs program by managing faculty assignments, resource allocation, and curriculum standardization, while collaborating with senior leadership to ensure alignment with institutional goals and delivering consistent, high-quality student experiences that promote leadership, collaboration, and skill development.

Instructional Roles

- AP Computer Science: Modernized departmental standards by designing an AP-aligned curriculum with reusable starter code, rubrics, and spiral review systems to ensure exam readiness.

- AP Psychology: Directed instruction in research methods and experimental design, emphasizing evidence-based reasoning and data-driven interpretation.
- English Language Arts (Grade 11): Managed a college-preparatory curriculum focused on American literature and high-level argumentative writing.

English Teacher | **Beijing Haidian Foreign Language Tengfei School** | **August 2023 – August 2024**
Education Team | Beijing, China | Recommendation Letter

- Enhanced Grade 1 students' dictation accuracy and letter sound recognition by facilitating the Common Core State Standards curriculum through engaging exercises and interactive phonics activities, driving exceptional progress.
- Developed and executed dynamic lesson plans focused on mastering consonant-vowel-consonant words and sight words, significantly boosting phonemic awareness and accelerating language acquisition.

English Teacher | **Sahmyook Academy** | **November 2021 – August 2023**
Education Team | Seoul, Gyeonggi-do, South Korea | Recommendation Letter

- Seoul English Village Suyu Camp - Elevated communication competence among Grades 7-12 students by applying an immersive English curriculum, utilizing high-quality, conversation-based exercises in themed classrooms, as evidenced by performance indicators.
- Seoul Sahmyook Elementary School - Drove a significant increase in reading comprehension and vocabulary retention by implementing personalized reading strategies and interactive, context-based learning activities, measured through proprietary metrics.

Engineering Teacher | **Hello World Studio** | **May 2019 – May 2021**
Education Team | San Francisco, California, United States | Recommendation Letter

- Leveraged the K-12 Computer Science Teachers Association Standards curriculum to significantly raise test scores among Grade 4-6 students by implementing targeted instructional interventions driven by performance data.
- Amplified student retention and engagement by providing personalized mentorship through daily code reviews and strategic analysis of assessment results to pinpoint and develop key growth areas.

Front End Engineer | **Associate Development Group Inc** | **November 2020 – February 2021**
Engineering Team | New York, New York, United States | Recommendation Letter

- Streamlined legacy websites by reducing codebase by 25% through the implementation of reusable components.
- Optimized project completion rates by 10% through consistent progress updates and efficient communication.
- Transformed mockups into responsive websites with an average turnaround time of just 2 weeks per project.

Front End Engineer | **AlzCare Labs** | **October 2017 – May 2019**
Engineering Team | San Francisco, California, United States

- Improved component rendering speed from 12.7 to 8.5 milliseconds by reducing wasted renders.
- Collaborated with designers on the Zeplin platform to create responsive components from style guides.

Full Stack Engineer | **Cureus** | **January 2017 – September 2017**
Engineering Team | San Francisco, California, United States

- Built and deployed a CRUD Restful API using Ruby on Rails and JavaScript.
- Assisted and participated in the research, product design, development, and testing of software and tools.

Expertise

- Cross-Cultural Communication
- Curriculum & Unit Planning (AP-aligned)
- Differentiation & Scaffolding
- CS Tools (Visual Studio Code, Git/GitHub)
- Assessment Design & Data-Informed Instruction
- Student-Centered Facilitation
- Classroom Management & Routines
- Communication & Academic Language Support

Extracurricular

- **Co-Curricular Program Coordinator,** Pegasus California School — **August 2024 - Present**
- **Coding Coach Mentor,** Open Source Software Engineer — **April 2020**